



Djinguereber Mosque

Location Timbuktu, Mali

The Djinguereber Mosque is the oldest and largest of Timbuktu's three great mosques. It was built in the 14th century, when the city was experiencing a long period of prosperity as an important West

African trading post and center of Islamic culture. The mosque is made out of earth, used in mud bricks and rendering, and has been regularly maintained using traditional techniques. One of its most prominent features is its pyramidal minaret with protruding wooden beams. The structure, and its intricate facade, was rebuilt and enlarged between 1570 and 1583 and is considered a symbol of Timbuktu's golden age.

Madrasa of Sultan Qaytbay

Location Cairo, Egypt

The Madrasa of Sultan Qaytbay, which sits in Cairo's old Islamic quarter, is one of the city's best-preserved and most highly regarded examples of Mamluk architecture. Completed in

1474, in the Egyptian capital's Northern Cemetery, it is a building complex containing a variety of structures—a mosque, a mausoleum, a minaret, a Qur'anic school, and a public well. A square courtyard sits at the heart of the site. The mosque and mausoleum are beautifully adorned, full of rich carvings and patterns made of marble. The mausoleum also features an intricately decorated dome.